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Hiring Committee
Keystone Strategy
116 Huntington Avenue, 12th Floor
Boston, MA 02116

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Economic Strategy Consultant position at Keystone Strategy. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary areas of specialization are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda is focused on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate distributions of wealth similar to those that we can measure empirically. A contributing factor to wealth accumulation over the life cycle is the rate of return earned on assets, so understanding the available data on wealth holding and methods to compute measures of returns is of much importance to my work. These topics are directly relevant to consulting engagements at Keystone Strategy, where advanced economic modeling, data science, and strategic insights support clients in technology, industrial sectors, and financial services.

In my job market paper, I match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by simulating a model in which households differ in the return earned on their assets. This modeling choice is motivated by the recent literature which documents substantial heterogeneity in portfolio returns across individuals, even within narrowly defined asset classes. In another research project, I analyze the relationship between trust and returns measured in the Health and Retirement Study. It is known that the empirical relationship between trust and measures of economic performance like income is hump-shaped — an intermediate amount of trust is associated with the maximal level of income. Not only am I able to replicate the hump-shaped relationship found in the literature in the HRS data, but I find that a similar relationship also holds for the constructed measure of returns. I also characterize the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth (a finding that motivated the modeling choices in my job market paper) for multiple waves of the HRS data.

Keystone Strategy's differentiated value — combining economic expertise, advanced analytics, and strategy consulting for leading clients navigating disruption — aligns closely with the questions I study. The firm's emphasis on applying rigorous quantitative methods, machine-learning-augmented insights, and clear, actionable presentation to executives is a natural fit for my capabilities. I would welcome the opportunity to translate my technical work into client-facing deliverables, strategic insights, and data-driven models that drive value for Keystone's clients.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate

models that speak to corporate strategy, regulatory and competitive challenges such as digital transformation, competitive positioning, and value creation under uncertainty, and (iii) collaborate across multidisciplinary teams to present insights in concise, actionable formats for a client audience. I am excited by Keystone Strategy's project-based, intellectually rigorous consulting environment, where academic modeling meets business strategy — a context in which I expect my work to generate meaningful influence.

I would welcome the chance to discuss how my research program could support Keystone Strategy's agenda. I do not have a preference regarding practice area or office location, and would be glad to contribute wherever my analytical capabilities are most needed.

Sincerely,

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